

The Lizards Of Us

Achillea, Ruby, Necro and I met up at Shu Feng Keep in hopes of finally being able to help our allies. As we were crossing the river towards Juran Tallwoods, Necro suddenly gets hit by a flaming frog statue that fell from the sky. That has been a phenomenon that is happening more frequently lately as well as a sort of effect in the sky that illuminates it in a dance full of bright colors. Luckily we crossed the river without any more of such issues. It wasn't long into our journey through the woods before a Kecuala patrol found us. We got informed that chief Therela had more information so we joined them and traveled to the village.

When we arrived at the village, the chief welcomed us again. Since the last time we were here, the Vrael Olo had managed to build a fortress around the luxum beast skeleton. The fortress itself and the clan were led by 3 leaders. We were tasked with infiltrating the fortress and killing their leaders. Therela supplied us with rooms to stay for the night and we pressed on at early sunrise.

It took us a few hours of travel before we got close, thanks to the two guards that showed us the way. By the time the sun was setting we had disguised ourselves as bushes and inched closer to the fortress to come up with a plan. We came to a clearing where the trees had been cut down. We saw a well protected area, a big wall surrounding what we assumed would be the skeleton and some buildings. Outside there were 5 guard towers around the settlements and another two right next to the wall.

With some careful sneaking around we managed to ambush one of the guard towers and interrogate one of the guards. We got some information about the 3 leaders and that the only way inside of the fortress is through the tunnels that they dug. Back in the guard tower we had also spotted a gear that when turned would flood said tunnels as a defensive mechanism. After we extracted all of the information we could, Achillea, Ruby and I went through the tunnels and Necro waited outside of the wall with his velociraptors.

We snuck around and managed to infiltrate the main hall by climbing through a bedroom window. We worked methodically, starting from the basement. In the basement we found snake pits, where Achillea managed to assassinate the unsuspecting sleeping yuanti before they became a threat. We moved further up again and cleared the floor with the bedrooms and then headed to the first floor. We heard several voices inside and recognised that one of them was one of the leaders. I later learned that Necro was keeping himself busy by wrestling giant coral snakes and hunting even more snakes. It seems like he truly enjoyed himself. After some preparation we stormed the room and took care of the hostiles.

Next, we snuck towards the back of the mess hall. I looked through a crack to see inside but all I saw was an eye staring back at me. This was one of the leaders, the unhinged one the guard warned us about. Achillea thought of a smart plan on the spot and cleverly managed to trick the leader into thinking I was the leader we had just killed. The distraction lasted long enough for us to be able to quickly get inside and finish her off.

After the battle had ended we heard the screams of a Kecualan prisoner downstairs. We carefully made our way down and rescued her, avoiding the many traps that were set up. It is then that we heard the alarms going off, the guard's shifts were changing and evidence of our infiltration had been found. We did however cleverly set up a trap. Using the trap wires we disabled we set up the trigger mechanism for the bomb that it was previously attached to. We made enough noise for the flood of reinforcements to come towards the mess hall. While they were running down the stairs we were long gone. Snuck through the back and at a safe distance when they detonated the trap. After the explosion it was easy enough to take care of the last guards stationed in the towers outside. We waited there until the last leader arrived. We knew from the interrogation that it would take a while before the last one arrived. But when he did, he made the mistake of coming alone so it wasn't before long that we took him out too.

Apparently when all of this was going down Necro hunted more and more snakes, as well as making friends with some of the guards it seemed. He spoke of many tales involving his snakes and showing off with the tricks he taught the velociraptors. Somehow I got the impression that he was being truthful about his adventures.

After this long mission we managed to secure the fortress for our allies and make sure the luxum skeleton remained unharmed.